



StockWatch

An inventory dashboard for the campus print shop

From the logs



69

LOG LINES

11

ERRORS

13

WARNINGS

The problem



- The campus print shop kept running out of paper and toner before exams
- Staff tracked paper and toner stock in a spreadsheet

What I built



- A small inventory dashboard for the print shop
- Flask API on top of the existing sheet export
- SQLite stores the stock history
- Low-stock alerts go out by email
- Weekly usage chart with a reorder suggestion

Three days of building



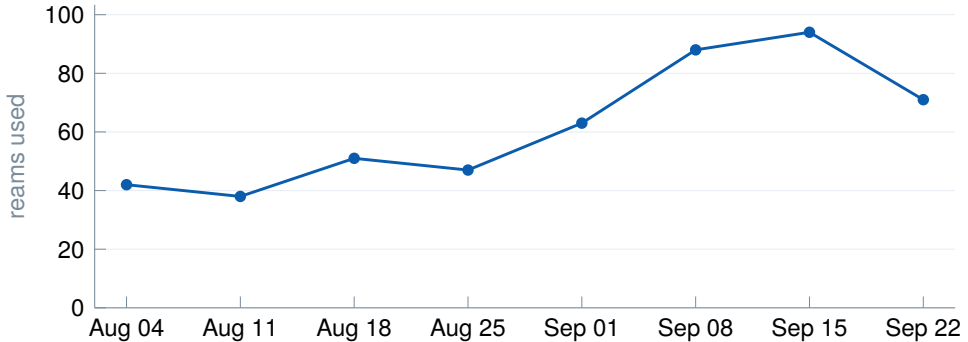
- Day 1: Flask API over the sheet export, SQLite for history
- Day 2: low-stock alerts by email
- Day 3: weekly usage chart and reorder suggestions

The reorder suggestion

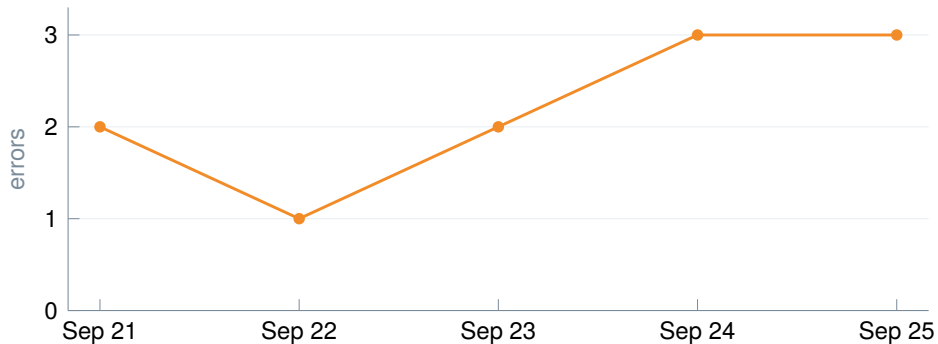


- It takes the average usage over the last 4 weeks
- Then it adds a buffer on top

Reams used per week



Errors over time



What was hard



- The sheet export has merged cells
- Dates show up in two different formats
- I wrote a cleaner that normalises both
- SMTP kept timing out on the campus network
- So alerts now go through a queue with retries

What's next



- Barcode scanning for restocks
- A shared login for the two shop staff